



Internship Interview Prep

Tips for the virtual interview

Before the interview

- Download and install the Microsoft Teams application on your device.
- Log in and familiarize yourself with mute, video and screen-sharing functions. You may need to update your computer permissions to allow screen-sharing.
- Find a well-lit area with a simple background and minimal distractions.
- If this is your first time doing a virtual interview, practice with someone who can give you honest feedback on your answers, presentation and delivery.
- Business casual is appropriate – no need for formal attire. Wear whatever makes you most comfortable.
- Silence your cell phone but keep it nearby. If technical issues arise, your interviewers may call you directly to finish the interview.

During the interview

- Plan to join your interview session five minutes early to allow time to troubleshoot potential technical snags logging in.
- If you are first to log in, wait for your interviewer to admit you to the meeting.
- Remain stationary during the interview.

Preparing for your interview

Depending on the team and position you are interviewing for, you may receive a mix of behavioral and technical questions.

Behavioral questions

Behavioral questions help predict general job fit and future success in the role during the hiring process. These questions ask about past experiences, accomplishments and specific situations relevant to job skills, decision-making, priorities, business focus and other aspects of the role.

To tackle these questions, we recommend the STAR method:

- **Situation** - What was the situation?
- **Task** - What was the task in question?
- **Action** - What action did you take to complete the task?
- **Result** - What was the outcome of that action?

To best prepare for behavioral questions:

- Review the job description and requirements.
- Consider specific examples of work experience, academic training and technical abilities demonstrative of your capacity to excel in the role.
- Detail these examples for interviewers' reference in your resume.

Practice behavioral questions:

- What makes you the most qualified candidate for the role?
- What is a difficult challenge you have faced?
- What has been your proudest achievement?
- When have you solved a problem with limited resources?
- Why do you want to work at Tesla?

Technical questions

Technical questions are difficult to anticipate, but this shouldn't deter you. Use the opportunity to showcase your technical skills and problem-solving abilities.

- Have a pencil and paper ready to take notes and work through the question.
- Ask clarifying questions. If you need more information to understand what is being asked, you can ask the interviewer for additional details or context.
- If your answer includes assumptions, state them so the interviewer can understand your thought process.
- Approach problems with First Principles Thinking. Dissect the problem to its most basic components and work your way up from fundamental truths.
- Detail your approach to the problem and how you plan to arrive at the solution.
- Instead of memorizing talking points, consider every question thoughtfully. For technical challenges, the interviewer may value a compelling thought process more than a correct answer.

After the interview

- Your recruiter will contact you regarding the next steps after your interview.
- If you would like to send your interviewers a thank you note, your recruiter can pass it on for you.

Thank you for your time and interest.
We hope to see you at Tesla.